



Tool: Blueprint for Building Your AI People Strategy

What Is an AI People Strategy?

An intentional set of design choices that align talent, organizational capability, and culture to embed AI across the enterprise.

Benefits

For HR

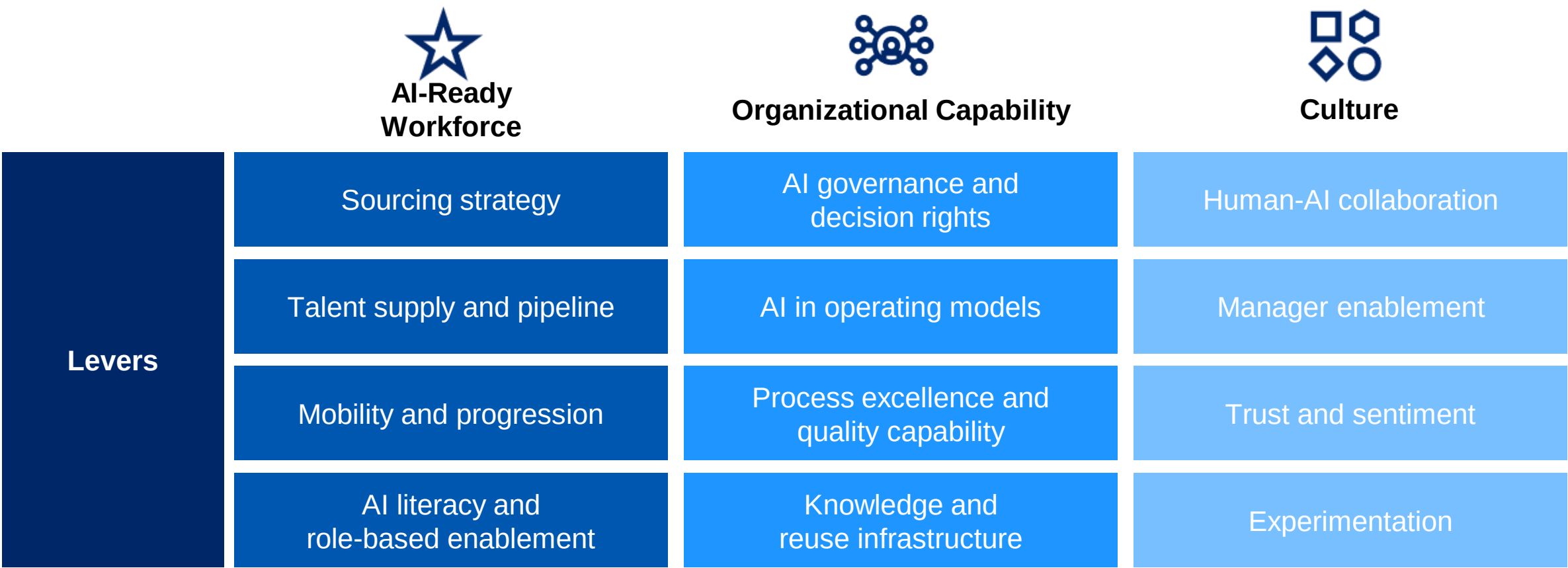
Moves HR upstream shaping how AI transforms work and talent.

For Enterprises

Better people outcomes, faster time to value, clearer decision rights, and greater agility.

Gartner's position: AI investment alone is not enough. True value comes from aligning AI initiatives with business strategy and proactively preparing people for change. Without a clear AI people strategy, enterprises risk underdelivering on AI's promise.

The Components of an AI People Strategy



How to Use This Guide

Consider the next sections as **inputs** to shape your **AI people strategy**. Approach talent, organizational capability, and culture as interconnected drivers. Advance them together to avoid over-investing in one at the expense of the others, which hinders AI adoption. This guide is NOT a checklist, use it to **pinpoint and prioritize actions** that address the most critical gaps in your enterprise.

For each of the three drivers — talent, organizational capability, and culture — you’ll find:

Goal	The outcome to achieve
Lever	Key choices HR must make to reach the goal
What this lever does	The specific challenge each lever addresses
Quick win	Tactical actions HR can take to build momentum
Pressure-Testing Questions	Questions to pressure-test the levers. If these cannot be answered clearly, further refinement is needed
Success metrics	How to measure if the strategy is working
What good looks like	Clear description of what effective execution looks like in practice

(Blueprint)



Build the AI-Ready Workforce

Goal: Ensure the enterprise has the right mix of AI builders, translators, and users to execute the enterprise AI strategy today, and evolve it tomorrow.

Lever	What This Lever Does	Quick Win	Pressure-Testing Questions	Success Metric
1 Define Your Sourcing Strategy	Defines when to Buy, Build, or Borrow AI talent (e.g. data scientists) and AI-adjacent talent (e.g. model risk managers).	Actively fund AI Ph.D. sponsorships or fellowships to secure deep AI expertise.	<i>Where should we buy, build, or borrow AI and AI-adjacent talent?</i>	Percentage of AI-critical roles with clearly defined sourcing paths.
2 Develop a Talent Supply and Pipeline	Ensures a sustained pipeline of AI capability from early career through senior leadership, protecting execution capacity and leadership continuity.	Launch an internal “AI Fellowship” to accelerate the development of AI expertise among emerging leaders and technical talent.	<i>Do we have visible rotational leadership programs and defined career pathways to ensure our AI talent continues to grow internally?</i>	Number of internal candidates in AI talent pipeline at each career stage.
3 Enable Mobility and Progression	Creates visible AI career paths that support career growth and retention.	Publish new career maps that highlight how AI skills open doors to advancement in key functions.	<i>What career paths exist for roles materially changing due to AI?</i>	Number of employees advancing into AI-augmented or newly-created AI roles.
4 Advance AI Literacy and Role-based Enablement	Prevents an “AI elite” by distributing role-specific learning broadly, anchored in practical AI use cases.	Launch an “AI in Action” training series tailored to the roles most impacted by AI.	<i>Do employees have role specific guidance on how to apply AI in their work?</i>	Percentage of employees completing AI training or engaged in AI-related work.

What good looks like: “We are explicit about which roles build AI, which shape it, and which use it. No one is guessing where they fit.”



Strengthen Organizational Capability

Goal: Make AI a repeatable enterprise capability by integrating it into governance, workflows, and operating models, with HR actively shaping workforce readiness from the start.

Lever	What This Lever Does	Quick Win	Pressure-Testing Questions	Success Metric
1 Clarify AI Governance and Decision Rights	Assesses where AI decisions sit, how major AI decisions are governed, and how people risk and workforce impacts are represented in steering bodies.	Map current AI decision rights and propose a revised governance structure that includes HR representation.	<i>Where does AI decision authority formally sit today?</i> <i>Is HR equipped to advise the C-Suite on workforce impact related to AI?</i>	Percentage of AI initiatives with HR involvement in governance or decision-making.
2 Redesign Work and Operating Models	Ensures AI is embedded into workflows, not treated as a parallel initiative, with AI use cases moving from idea to deployment through standard operating processes.	Pilot a 2-4 week AI redesign of an HR process (e.g., candidate screening) to demonstrate value and build practical skills.	<i>Can AI use cases move from idea to deployment through standard operating processes, without exceptions or heroics?</i>	Number of business processes or workflows with AI embedded as standard practice.
3 Build Process Excellence and Quality Capability	Promotes process excellence and quality management, enhancing workforce skills in process modeling, dashboard analysis, and data validation.	Collaborate with the business to quickly map and improve a high-impact process using AI.	Are value streams regularly optimized through process review and improvement?	Outcome improvement in AI-enabled processes (savings, cycle time, customer/employee experience)
4 Institutionalize Knowledge and Reuse Infrastructure	Ensures AI use cases, decisions, and outcomes are systematically captured, shared, and reused throughout the enterprise.	Set up a central repository for AI use cases and lessons learned, inviting teams to contribute and access resources.	<i>How are AI lessons, use cases, and outcomes captured and reused across the enterprise?</i>	Number of AI use cases or artifacts reused across teams.

What good looks like: “We have clear AI decision owners, simple use case paths, shared learning across teams, and HR helps the business move faster, safer, and with clearer people outcomes.”



Build a Culture of Trust and Safety

Goal: Create the trust, safety, and shared understanding that allow AI adoption to scale without resistance, disengagement, or hidden risk.

Lever	What This Lever Does	Quick Win	Pressure-Testing Questions	Success Metric
1 Reinforce Norms for Human-AI Collaboration	Establishes clear AI use principles that address ethics, fairness, data privacy, accountability, and employee rights.	Publish and distribute an “AI Principles and Employee Rights” guide that outlines expectations and escalation paths.	<i>Do employees know how to use AI tools responsibly?</i> <i>Are employees aware of the proper escalation path if issues arise?</i>	Percentage of employees aware of AI use principles.
2 Empower Managers as Change Leaders	Clarifies how managers are equipped and expected to lead teams through AI-driven change, address concerns, and uphold psychological safety.	Roll out a manager toolkit and training focused on leading AI-augmented teams and supporting employee questions.	<i>What skills do managers need to lead AI-augmented teams?</i>	Percentage of managers trained to lead AI change.
3 Monitor Trust and AI Sentiment	Establishes how the enterprise listens for, measures, and responds to employee trust, fairness, and risk as AI reshapes work.	Conduct a trust pulse survey after each major AI deployment and share the results and next steps enterprisewide.	<i>Are we transparent about where work will change, not just improve?</i>	Employee trust or engagement score related to AI from pulse surveys.
4 Encourage Experimentation	Encourage employees to engage with AI through clear guardrails, supported experimentation, and recognition.	Host a quarterly “AI Learning Forum” where teams share both wins and lessons learned from experimentation.	<i>How do we handle mistakes, bias, or failed experiments publicly?</i>	Number of employees or teams recognized for AI experimentation.

What good looks like: “We talk about AI in plain language. We acknowledge uncertainty. We reward learning. People feel informed, not surprised.”

(Templates)



Build the AI-Ready Workforce

Fillable Template

Build the AI-ready workforce	Goal: Ensure the organization has the right mix of AI builders, translators, and users to execute the enterprise AI strategy today, and evolve it tomorrow.			
Levers	Define Sourcing Strategy	Develop Talent Supply and Pipeline	Enable Mobility and Progression	Advance AI Literacy and Role-based Enablement
Specific Actions	• <i>Specific Actions</i>	• <i>Specific Actions</i>	• <i>Specific Actions</i>	• <i>Specific Actions</i>
Success Metrics	<i>Example: Percentage of AI-critical roles with clearly defined sourcing paths.</i>	<i>Example: Number of internal candidates in the AI talent pipeline at each career stage.</i>	<i>Example: Percentage of employees completing AI training or engaged in AI-related work.</i>	<i>Example: Number of employees advancing into AI-augmented or newly created AI roles.</i>



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Fillable Template

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Lever	Clarify AI Governance and Decision Rights	Redesign Work and Operating Models	Build Process Excellence and Quality Capability	Institutionalize Knowledge and Reuse Infrastructure
Specific Actions	• <i>Specific Actions</i>	• <i>Specific Actions</i>	• <i>Specific Actions</i>	• <i>Specific Actions</i>
Success Metrics	<i>Example: Percentage of AI initiatives with HR involvement in governance or decision-making.</i>	<i>Example: Number of business processes or workflows with AI embedded as standard practice.</i>	<i>Example: Outcome improvement in AI-enabled processes.</i>	<i>Example: Number of AI use cases, lessons learned or artifacts.</i>



Build a Culture of Trust and Safety

Fillable Template

Build a Culture of Trust and Safety	Goal: Build the trust, safety, and shared understanding that allow AI adoption to scale without resistance, disengagement, or hidden risk.			
Lever	Reinforce Norms for Human-AI Collaboration	Empower Managers as Change Leaders	Monitor Trust and AI Sentiment	Encourage Experimentation
Specific Actions	• <i>Specific Actions</i>	• <i>Specific Actions</i>	• <i>Specific Actions</i>	• <i>Specific Actions</i>
Success Metrics	<i>Example: Percentage of employees aware of AI use principles.</i>	<i>Example: Percentage of managers trained to lead AI change.</i>	<i>Example: Employee trust or engagement score related to AI from pulse surveys.</i>	<i>Example: Number of employees or teams recognized for AI experimentation.</i>

Recommended Reading

- [Every Enterprise Needs an AI People Strategy: Here's How CHROs Can Build One](#)
- [The Pillars of a Successful Artificial Intelligence Strategy](#)
- [AI Maturity Assessment](#)